

# Action, Trajectories and Gaps: A Research Programme

navstokgap research working notes

9 September 2026 — programme version 22

## Abstract

We organize the study of mechanical action scales around exact trajectories, fluctuation spectra and operational resolution. A sequence from constant force through oscillator and central-potential models leads to two research targets: quantum reconstruction and a mechanism for gap formation. Each work package has a mathematical object, deliverable and acceptance gate. Relativistic and PDE/field-theory comparisons track how estimates behave under changes of scale. The maintained source is `research/PROGRAMME.md`; task state and handoffs support continuation across research sessions.

## 1 Research programme: action, trajectories and gaps

Version 22, 2026-09-09.

### 1.1 Aim

**Hard verification rule (2026-09-09):** mathematical work uses written proofs and source review. Creating or running Python numerical/symbolic verification scripts is prohibited for coordinator and workers. Existing scripts are historical artifacts, even where older task entries mention checks. Document and source-management tooling remains allowed; switching languages is not a workaround. A new computational-verification workflow requires user direction.

Explain the relationship between mechanical trajectories, an action scale and gap formation. We pursue two connected outcomes:

1. A reconstruction of quantum mechanics from explicit physical premises, with a derivation of the role and necessity of an action parameter.
2. A rigorous toy model that identifies which Lagrangians, state spaces and boundary conditions produce a positive lower bound.

Newton's shrinking-area construction provides the initial geometric model. The work proceeds through exact mechanical examples, operational definitions, operator spectra and comparisons of limiting procedures.

The user's strong target (2026-09-06) is to identify independently motivated physical principles that force quantum structure with a positive action parameter, with classical mechanics recovered as a specified limit. This has two proof obligations: exclusion of the classical model under the selected principles, and construction of the classical limit. The statement that every admissible classical theory has a quantum completion is a further universal claim whose domain and notion of quantisation must be fixed.

Solvable-model spectra and sector gaps are test cases for this programme. Each result has a separate librarian audit of prior literature, recording established matches, derived consequences or a candidate contribution with explicit search coverage. The strong target receives its own prior-art audit as its axioms and quantifiers become precise.

## 1.2 Current priority: bound action and scale selection

**M07/B28 are complete.** The Kepler note and gap laboratory specify the regular bound domain and angular-action threshold  $k/c$  (C052). A softened core admits bound circles for every positive angular action at fixed coupling and speed limit (C053); the core-collapse limit explains the domain change. One Luna-low follow-up audit and coordinator written proof/source review support these results.

**A15/B29 are complete:** the bound-orbit note compares transport and conditional variance with twice the canonical covariance area. The latter equals orbital action for uniform circular phase; each phase preparation conserves its own value. C054–C055 include the window-ratio bound and singular/softened threshold transfer. **A16/B30 are complete:** the dilation note proves a conditional zero-infimum theorem for contraction-closed model classes (C056–C057). **A17/B31 are complete:** one fixed smooth force-bounded potential has stable small circles of vanishing action, while an independent speed floor gives a positive circular bound (C058–C059). **A18/B32 are complete:** total turning extends this sharp bound to closed regular trajectories (C060–C061), with Milnor’s curvature theorem audited. **A19 is next:** test a peak-excitation premise allowing speed to vanish at turning points. The singular-core benchmark remains coupling-dependent; the softened model tests the extra premise needed for a positive infimum. B27 supplies the established Boyer classification and B28 the bounded follow-up.

Keep the transport laboratory and its preparation tests. **A14** is the next bounded renewal calculation; **A16** tests scale-changing transformations against the axioms. **R02** audits the repaired finite-propagation draft, and **G03** extends spectral control beyond independent products. The new idea card specifies the observables and limits; TASKS governs dispatch. Quantum reconstruction Q01 and the Newton-specific historical source questions retain their separate gates.

## 1.3 Milestone history: composition and scale selection

The following dated milestones preserve the development of the programme; their next-step wording records earlier decisions, superseded by the priority above.

**A13/B26 are complete.** Ordered streams give zero response at the same mass, speed, density and mean collision rate as the Poisson receiver, through periodic cancellation. **A14** now tests stationary renewal streams at fixed mean gap: derive the tagged variance growth and how it depends on gap variance. The target is quantitative control of preparation, beyond a mean collision rate.

**A12/B25 are complete.** The collision manuscript derives the clock  $\lambda = \rho u$  from independent spatial gaps in a two-speed equal-mass gas, giving  $H_* = mu/\rho$  with a common hard speed ceiling. **A13** next changes spacing correlations at fixed mass, speed and density, testing which part of the response is selected by preparation.

**A11/B24 are complete.** The consolidated receiver paper gives a periodic chain plateau  $\Theta\sqrt{m/k}$  in one order of limits, zero in the reverse order, and closure under a common hard speed ceiling in the stated phase preparation. **A12** next selects a bounded-velocity interacting receiver and its invariant preparation, before attempting a low-frequency response proof. A06/A09a are consolidated in one return-bridge manuscript; the paper review identifies further A01–A09 groupings while preserving distinct hypotheses.

**A10/B23 are complete.** Finite conservative harmonic receivers give an exact cosine covariance and vanishing long-window action observable at fixed centre velocity. Random centre velocity gives ballistic variance instead. **A11** now specifies an increasing network and its preparation: determine the tagged low-frequency spectral weight and compare the receiver-size and window limits. Harmonic-bath sources supply a reduced memory equation; its friction kernel must be distinguished from the tracer covariance. This advances the mechanical origin and preparation-independence gates of the action-selection target.

**G02/B22 are complete.** Weakening observable access can keep an action plateau fixed while the full gap closes, even with distinct velocity states. Independent composition instead

lets local-frame bounds control mixed modes. **A10 is next:** a specified finite conservative harmonic receiver, with its normal-mode correlation, preparation dependence and centre-motion convention. Compare refinement, long observation and reservoir-size limits to determine which physical premise could sustain the positive action target. A09 retains the universal coherent-action identification.

**A07/B21 are complete.** The bounded-turn paper gives a positive endpoint-conditioned kinetic cost and a vanishing polygon error under uniform acceleration control. **G02 is next:** access to internal modes and observability under composition. The mechanical follow-up must specify a conservative receiver; A09 retains the universal scale-selection task.

**G01/B20 are complete.** The spectral-control note gives a lower gap bound from an observable frame and bounded summed susceptibility. Its hidden-label example keeps the velocity plateau fixed while the full gap closes. **A07 is next:** bounded-acceleration mechanical turns and their action scales. G02 tests observability under weaker access and composition. A09 retains the preparation-independent quantum-role target.

**A09b/B18 are complete.** The checkerboard note proves the normalized Dirac wavepacket limit and a repeated-measurement ballistic cut limit. C039–C040 separate a classical flip probability from a coherent corner amplitude. G01 supplies the subsequent spectral-control test. A09 retains the physical premise identifying the positive plateau with the coherent action parameter, across preparations.

**A09a/B17 are complete.** The crossover note derives a beta midpoint law and the exact interpolation from cubic short-window variance to the common long-window plateau. C038 proves that a fixed finite window and uniform speed ceiling cannot realize a positive shared coefficient over arbitrarily small masses. A09b supplies the subsequent direct checkerboard source passages and real-versus-complex two-component comparison.

**A08/B16 are complete.** The composition note proves that a nonnegative mass-only coefficient preserved by independent composition is constant on positive masses. A finite-rate, nonzero-speed reference makes the common Green–Kubo plateau positive. C035–C036 retain the preparation-class premise, and product-state closure accommodates more than two centre velocities. The original priority decision and its countertests follow.

The six-direction review promotes **A08** to the next main task: derive the mass-composition law for a nonnegative action coefficient and test its physical premises. Distinguish mass independence within one preparation class from independence of environment, and coefficient closure from closure of the composite trajectory law. The deliverable is a short proof note, five algebra checks and one sequential Luna-low prior-art audit. C033–C034 already belong to A06; new claims keep new IDs.

**A09** combines the finite-speed crossover bound with the checkerboard source route. Verify real probability and complex-amplitude recurrences separately; compare stationary-increment and conditioned-midpoint observables. The B15 source companion records verified 1984 identifiers and remaining direct-passage obligations. The Compton-scale substitution uses an additional identification with  $\hbar$ ; particle creation is a separate field-theory construction.

**G01** now has a concrete finite-state model: the velocity-generator gap and its susceptibility product. Include a slow-mode observability counterest before seeking a lower gap estimate transferable to WP6. A03/A05/A06 close the chosen cut-consistency constructions; their observables remain distinct in the central selection problem. **A07** stays available as the bounded-force diagnostic. M03 retains its independent proof/build gates, and B11 is ready for its saved geometry audit. This reprioritization leaves the accepted claim set unchanged.

## 1.4 Starting results

**A01** establishes a positive action plateau from finite reversible velocity memory:  $H_* = 2m\langle v, (-Q)^{-1}v \rangle_\pi$ , with the two-velocity value  $mu^2/\lambda$ . The paper and B09 audit separate established transport formulas from their action-valued consequences. **A02** adds physical-time

covariance relaxation in an elastic bath, with plateau  $(m + M)s^2/\nu$  set by reservoir parameters. The completed **A03** cut-point test proves that exact Gaussian restriction consistency fixes its fluctuation parameter, while the finite-defect scaling changes retained-node marginals. Each inserted node contributes mean kinetic action  $\kappa/2$  at fixed preparation. **A05** adds an elastic physical-cut example and the sharp finite-speed midpoint bound  $\kappa_{\text{mid}} \leq m\Delta(u - |v|)^2$ . Its convolution theorem identifies the need for memory in a stochastic finite-speed refinement model. **A06** now supplies a bridge retaining both position and velocity: the exact return law has a midpoint atom, consistent cut restrictions and vanishing polygon action error. **A07** replaces impulses by bounded acceleration and tests sharp return-duration and kinetic-action bounds at fixed endpoint velocities. The bath results remain diagnostics within the broader target. Necessity, convergence, universality and identification with  $\hbar$  remain separate proof obligations. M06 and spectral examples support this central task.

The two-regulator calculation proves an exact finite action-defect limit. With  $d = N - 1$  internal positions,  $\kappa_N \rightarrow 0$  and  $d\kappa_N \rightarrow \ell$ , Gaussian polygonal bridges converge uniformly to the classical path while their excess action converges in  $L^2$  to  $\ell/2$ . Classical Paths with a Finite Action Defect also supplies the partition determinant, a strict-speed oscillatory example, quadratic stationary-phase normalization and an explicit bare-coefficient map. B08 provides its per-result source and proof audit. M06 next tests force control and the relativistic kinetic action on the oscillatory sequence.

The current refinement experiment is an exact free-particle blocking map. Gaussian kernels compose while preserving their action parameter; endpoint bridges concentrate on the Newtonian straight path as that parameter tends to zero. Time Refinement and an Action Scale gives the proofs and identifies the open physical selection step. The source-to-model note connects this test to Plutarch's cone, Rivero's regulator proposal, Brouder's rooted-tree algebra and tangent-groupoid quantization.

Bibliography is an input to model design as well as a prior-art check. Every bounded reading should return a premise to test, a construction to implement, or a proof obligation to resolve. Read only the passages needed for the current calculation; use one small worker at a time, followed by coordinator review.

For  $V = -Fy$ , duration  $T > 0$ , perpendicular launch speed  $v_0 > 0$  and mass  $m > 0$ , the chord-curve action difference is

$$\Delta S = \frac{F^2 T^3}{24m} = \frac{F}{2v_0} \mathcal{A}_{\text{lens}} = \frac{T\delta E}{12}, \quad \delta E = \Delta K = -\Delta V.$$

The variation  $\eta(t) = at(T - t)$  gives  $\Delta S = ma^2 T^3/6$ . Thus positive action differences in this fixed-endpoint class have infimum zero. The chord is an off-shell comparison path; the parabola solves the constant-force equation. This identifies admissibility of neighbouring paths as a substantive choice for the proposed gap mechanism.

A second result concerns quantum measurement. For two known, equally likely two-arm pure states whose relative phase is  $\Delta S/\hbar$ ,  $N$  independent copies and arbitrary joint binary measurements give the first-lobe threshold

$$d_{N,p} = 2\hbar \arccos\left([4p(1-p)]^{1/(2N)}\right), \quad |\Delta S| \leq \pi\hbar, \quad \frac{1}{2} < p \leq 1.$$

Success probability at least  $p$  is achievable exactly when  $|\Delta S| \geq d_{N,p}$ . For fixed  $\frac{1}{2} < p < 1$ , this threshold scales as  $N^{-1/2}$ ; perfect discrimination has threshold  $\pi\hbar$  for every finite  $N$ . The calculation connects an action difference to a resource-dependent resolution.

The technical paper supplies the proofs, the Jacobi-operator calculation and the normalized free-kernel limit. The ledger records their evidence and review status.

## 1.5 Questions and mathematical objects

| Target                     | Question                                                                                              | Starting point                             |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Q0: classical existence    | Which force regularity, initial data and collision conventions give unique global trajectories?       | Constant force; next, central potentials   |
| Q1: action-value gap       | Is the infimum of positive matched-endpoint action differences positive on the chosen path class?     | Infimum zero for the constant-force family |
| Q2: action scale           | Which physical premises force a universal parameter with action units to be positive?                 | Reconstruction axiom comparison            |
| Q3: operational bound      | How do protocol, resources and error target determine action resolution?                              | Exact two-arm finite-copy threshold        |
| Q4: spectral gap           | Which self-adjoint operator has a separated ground sector, and how does its gap depend on parameters? | Dirichlet Hessian and quantum Hamiltonian  |
| Q5: transfer across limits | Which estimates survive continuum and infinite-volume limits and interactions?                        | Companion PDE/field-theory comparisons     |

Use  $h = 2\pi\hbar$  for Planck's constants,  $\eta$  for trajectory variations,  $J$  for a fluctuation operator and  $\chi$  for a proposed additional field. Use matched endpoints when comparing actions under additions of  $dG(q, t)/dt$ .

## 1.6 Model sequence

1. **Constant force:** derive the area–action relation and study small variations.
2. **Harmonic oscillator:** compare the duration-dependent Hessian eigenvalues with the quantum Hamiltonian spacing. Track normalization and conjugate times.
3. **Free line, circle and box:** isolate confinement and boundary conditions, and calculate gap closure as the spatial domain grows.
4. **Central potentials and Kepler:** establish IVP assumptions, collision continuation and action-angle variables; then compare quantum spectra.
5. **Interacting and multiwell models:** identify a gap-producing mechanism and its dependence on coupling, tunnelling and limiting parameters.

## 1.7 Work packages

| Package          | Deliverable / acceptance gate                                                                          | Dependencies  |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| WP0: foundations | Restart instructions, ledger, tasks, source rules and LaTeX/PDF build                                  | Complete      |
| WP1: Newton      | Edition/folio concordance, six-scholium corpus and dated evidence for the publication-history question | Source access |

| Package                         | Deliverable / acceptance gate                                                                | Dependencies                |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| WP2: classical mechanics        | Proofs for constant force, regular central forces and specified Kepler collision cases       | Path class and topology     |
| WP3: fluctuations and kernels   | Jacobi operator/domain, conjugate times and normalized distributional limits                 | WP2                         |
| WP4: operational reconstruction | Measurement bounds and a dependency map of candidate quantum axioms                          | WP3; bibliography B01       |
| WP5: gap laboratory             | Operator domains, explicit bounds and parameter-dependent gap closure                        | Relevant WP2–4 results      |
| WP6: companion limits           | Relativistic, parabolic and quantum-field comparisons with a specified transferable estimate | WP5; Millennium definitions |
| WP7: papers and review          | Readable proofs, checked citations, reproduced results and selected formal certificates      | Accepted package result     |

Historical reading and mathematical calculations have separate task tracks. Delegate bounded tasks to Sol or Luna sequentially, with the coordinator waiting for each worker and reviewing its handoff before continuing. The finite-dimensional examples establish the definitions and estimates for the later field-theory comparison. A package finishes with a theorem, counterexample, conditional result or precisely stated open obligation.

## 1.8 Reconstruction branches

**Branch A: consequences of quantum premises.** Start with Hilbert states, Born probabilities and the phase  $e^{iS/\hbar}$  for a specified  $\hbar > 0$ . Derive operational bounds, spectra and their dependence on model parameters.

**Branch B: origin of quantum structure.** Choose operational premises about composition, continuity, reversible transformations and distinguishability. Construct models satisfying subsets of these premises and identify the step that selects quantum structure. Then establish how action enters the dynamics and what forces its scale to be positive. Numerical calibration is a further empirical task.

**Additional-field proposal.** Specify the field space, coupling and measure for  $S[q, \chi]$ , then calculate the effective action after eliminating  $\chi$ . The idea register sets out the candidate interpretations and their immediate tests.

## 1.9 Reading priorities

M05 and B07a have implemented the normalization audit of Rivero’s 1998 proposal and the common-observable construction in Wilson–Kogut §12.2. The next source-to-model note turns Rindler’s oscillation framework into M06’s force-control test. B07b retains the precise tangent-groupoid quantization hypotheses and their classical-limit topology. This ordering joins source reading to a named calculation.

Start Q01 with Hardy’s five axioms and Chiribella–D’Ariano–Perinotti’s informational derivation. Use Masanes–Müller as a third comparison. For each, trace how its premises constrain state spaces, transformations and composition.

Branch A draws on Feynman’s path-phase formulation, Wootters’s finite-sample statistical distance and the quantum Chernoff asymptotic error bound. The B01 batch records verified metadata and selected reading coverage. Full reconstruction-proof reading belongs to Q01.

### 1.10 $1/c$ , Navier–Stokes and Yang–Mills

Track  $\hbar$ ,  $c^{-1}$ , viscosity  $\nu$ , time and volume independently. The free relativistic particle retains the small-amplitude action family within a strict speed margin. The nonrelativistic quantum model retains  $\hbar > 0$  at  $c^{-1} = 0$ . These examples separate the roles of the two parameters.

A bridge must specify its source and target spaces, operators, physical or auxiliary time, units, preserved estimate and limits. The useful comparison is how coercivity and control of fluctuations survive changes of scale. For Navier–Stokes, the target is evolution regularity under the official hypotheses. For Yang–Mills, it includes the physical Hilbert space and a vacuum spectral gap through the continuum and infinite-volume limits.

### 1.11 Scope and publication

The programme’s reconstruction and gap-formation questions are open research targets. The present results concern the explicitly defined toy models; the Millennium problems supply comparison targets. Novelty and publication readiness will be assessed through literature comparison and specialist review.

Maintain human-readable proofs alongside calculations and formal artifacts. Record changes of model or target with their reasons. Submission, public posting, author correspondence and paid services require user direction. The user has authorized commits and pushes to the existing repository after each innovation or relevant status change (2026-09-07).